ProDEPLOY Backoffice

User Manual

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/10/This manual explains how to use the ProDEPLOY Backoffice: the web application in which you manage the applications, startup configurations and deployment packages that ProDVX devices install through the ProDEPLOY Client.

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1. Introduction

ProDEPLOY delivers software to ProDVX devices. Everything you publish in the Backoffice receives a short **deployment code**. A technician or end user types that code into the ProDEPLOY Client on a device (or taps an NFC tag that holds it) and the device downloads, installs and configures what the code stands for.

1.1 Key concepts

Term	Meaning
Application	An Android app (APK) that can be installed on a device, together with the hardware it needs.
Version	Each update of an application is stored as a new version. All versions of one application form a *family* and share one deployment code.
Startup Configuration	A set of device settings (Wi-Fi, time zone, display, and so on) in JSON format, handed to the ProDVX Startup Wizard.
Deployment Package	A bundle of several applications and at most one startup configuration, delivered with a single code.
Deployment code	A code of up to five capitals and digits, for example `K7MPA`, that identifies an application, a configuration or a package.
Requirements	The hardware an application needs. Devices that lack required hardware do not receive the application.

1.2 How a deployment works

1. You add an application, a startup configuration or a package in the Backoffice. ProDEPLOY assigns it a deployment code.
2. You pass the code to whoever installs the device, or write it to an NFC tag.
3. On the device, the code is entered in the ProDEPLOY Client.
4. ProDEPLOY checks the device model and Android version, and sends the newest compatible version of every application, plus the configuration if there is one.
5. The device downloads and installs the applications in order and applies the configuration last.

2. Getting started

2.1 Signing in

1. Open the Backoffice in your web browser.
2. Click **Click here to log in** on the welcome page, or open the menu and choose **Log In**.
3. Sign in, or create an account, on the login page that opens.
4. You return to the Backoffice. The welcome page greets you by name.

> **Note:** If the welcome page says your email is not yet verified, open the verification email (check your spam or junk folder) and follow the link before continuing.

A new account starts as a **Guest** and cannot open any of the management pages yet. Request access from `sales@prodvx.com` or from your ProDVX account manager. Once your role has been changed, log out and log in again so the new role takes effect.

2.2 Roles

What you can see and do depends on the role of your account.

Role	Access
Guest	Welcome page only.
Partner	Applications, Startup Configurations and Deployment Packages. Sees and manages only what they own, plus applications other users have shared.

2.3 Finding your way around

- **Menu** – the icon at the top left opens the side menu with the pages available to you, and **Log In** / **Log Out**. Click outside the menu or the cross to close it.
- **Page title** – the name of the current page appears in the middle of the top bar.
- **ProDEPLOY logo** – at the top right; click it to return to the welcome page.

Every management page works the same way:

- An **Add** button at the top left opens a form to create a new item.
- **Search by name** filters the list as you type.
- The **refresh** button reloads the list from the server. Use it when someone else may have made changes.
- **Click a row** to expand it and see its details and actions (**Edit**, **Delete** and so on). Click it again to collapse it.
- On the Applications page you can click a column heading to sort by it. Click again to reverse the

order.

- Small **i** and **?** buttons next to form fields explain the field when you point at them.

2.4 Reading deployment codes

Codes are shown in a grey box with letters in blue and digits in red, so that similar characters such as O and 0 are easy to tell apart. Codes that ProDEPLOY generates use the letters A–Z and the digits 1–9; they never contain a zero.

2.5 Logging out

Open the menu and choose **Log Out**. The lists stored in your browser are cleared, so the next person who uses the computer does not see your data.

3. Applications

The Applications page (menu: **Applications**) lists the applications you can deploy. Partners see their own applications; tick **Show shared applications** to also see applications other users have shared. Moderators always see every application, with an extra **Owner** column.

Column	Shows
URL	A link icon that opens the APK file.
Code	The deployment code of the application family.
Name	The application name.
Version	The version of this entry.
Shared	A group icon if the application is shared, a lock if it is private.
Owner	The email address of the owner (Moderators only).

Expanding a row shows the minimum Android version, the creation and last modified dates, the pre-granted permissions and the hardware requirements.

3.1 Adding an application

1. Click **Add Application**. The form *Submit new application* opens.
2. Fill in the fields described below.
3. Optionally click **Add requirements** to set the hardware the application needs (see 3.2).
4. Click **Submit**. The message "Application Saved" confirms that it was added, with a new deployment code.

Field	Description
Code	Moderators only. Leave empty to have a code generated, or enter up to five capitals and digits.
Name	The name shown in the Backoffice and on the device during installation. Required.
URL	A direct download link to the APK file. The link must download the file itself, not a web page about it. Required.
Version	The version number, for example `1.2.5`, `v2.0` or `1.2b`. See 3.6. Required.
Shared	Tick *Allow others to use this application* to let other users add it to their packages. You remain the only one who can change or delete it.

Field	Description
OS	The operating system. Currently fixed to Android.
Minimum SDK	The lowest Android SDK level the app supports (28 to 37), as declared in the app's Android manifest. See the table below.
Permissions	Tick *Pre-grant on install* to approve the app's runtime permissions automatically after installation, so nobody has to tap through permission prompts on the device.
Only these	Appears when pre-granting is on. Leave empty to grant every runtime permission the app declares, or pick permissions from the list to grant only those. You can also type a permission name such as `CAMERA` or `com.vendor.permission.SCAN` and press Enter.

Minimum SDK	Android version
28	Android 9
29	Android 10
30	Android 11
31 / 32	Android 12
33	Android 13
34	Android 14
35	Android 15
36	Android 16
37	Android 17

> **Note:** Only permissions that the app itself declares can be granted. A permission in the list that the app does not declare is ignored.

3.2 Requirements

Requirements describe the hardware an application needs. Click **Add requirements** in the form to show them and **Collapse Requirements** to hide them again.

Setting	Effect
Required	The application is only sent to devices on which this hardware is available (built in or external).
Optional	The application uses the hardware if present but works without it. Does not limit which devices receive it.
Not Used	The application does not use the hardware. This is the

Setting	Effect
	default.

You can set a requirement for NFC, Camera, LEDs, Microphone, Radar, Bluetooth and Wi-Fi, and a minimum and maximum screen size in inches.

> **Caution:** Requirements are restrictive. A device that does not meet them is simply not offered the application, so only mark hardware as Required when the application cannot work without it.

3.3 Adding an update (new version)

When you release a new version of an application, add it as an update instead of a new application. It then keeps the same deployment code and devices automatically receive the newest version.

1. Expand the application's row and click **Add Update**.
2. Enter the **URL** of the new APK and the new **Version**. The version must differ from the current one.
3. Adjust the minimum SDK, permissions or requirements if they have changed.
4. Click **Submit**.

> **Note:** A device always receives the newest version of an application. If that newest version requires hardware the device lacks, the device receives nothing for that application – it does not fall back to an older version.

3.4 Editing a version

Use **Edit** to correct a version in place, for example a wrong URL or requirement. Expand the row, click **Edit**, make the changes and click **Submit**.

Moderators can also change the deployment code here. A warning shows that the old code stops working once saved.

> **Caution:** Renaming a code breaks every NFC tag and printed sheet that still carries the old code. They must be redone.

3.5 Sharing an application

Click **Share** in the expanded row to let other users add the application to their deployment packages, and **Make private** to undo this. Sharing applies to every version of the application.

Applications shared by others show "Shared by *owner* – it can be added to your packages, but only its owner can change it." instead of the edit buttons.

3.6 Version numbers

ProDEPLOY uses the version number to decide which version is newest. A version consists of numbers

separated by dots, optionally with a `v` in front and letters at the end.

Comparison	Result
`2` and `1`	`2` is newer
`1.1` and `1.0`	`1.1` is newer
`1.1.0` and `1.0.1`	`1.1.0` is newer
`1.2b` and `1.2a`	`1.2b` is newer
`v1.2` and `1.2`	equal

3.7 Deleting an application

Expand the row and click **Delete**. This removes that version.

> **Caution:** Delete takes effect immediately; there is no confirmation step and it cannot be undone.

4. Startup Configurations

A startup configuration is a set of device settings that the ProDVX Startup Wizard applies, such as the Wi-Fi network, time zone, screen timeout and display orientation. The settings are written in JSON. The page is opened from the menu: **Startup Configurations**.

The list shows the **Code**, **Name** and **Description** of each configuration. Expanding a row shows the owner, the dates and the full configuration (read-only).

4.1 Adding a startup configuration

1. Click **Add Startup Configuration**.
2. Enter a **Name** and a **Description**.
3. Edit the **Configuration**. The editor starts with a complete default configuration; change the values you need.
4. Click **Submit**. "Configuration Saved" confirms it, and the configuration appears in the list with its deployment code.

The configuration must be valid JSON. The editor marks errors; if you submit while the text is invalid, the Backoffice asks you to fix the errors first.

4.2 Common settings

The table lists frequently changed settings from the default configuration. Keep the remaining settings as they are unless you know what they do.

Setting	Example	Purpose
`wifiSSID`	`"Office"`	Name of the Wi-Fi network to join.
`wifiPassword`	`"secret"`	Password of that network.
`hiddenNetwork`	`false`	Set to `true` if the network does not broadcast its name.
`ethernet`	`"DHCP"`	Ethernet mode; with a static setting, the `ethernetStatic…` values are used.
`timeZone`	`"Europe/Amsterdam"`	Time zone of the device.
`ntpService`	`"2.android.pool.ntp.org"`	Time server.
`languages`	`"EN-US"`	Device language.
`screenTimeout`	`1800`	Screen timeout.
`displayOrientation`	`0`	Rotation of the display.

Setting	Example	Purpose
`brightnessLevel`	`100`	Screen brightness.
`deviceName`	`"Reception"`	Name of the device.
`hideStatusBar`	`"Disable"`	Whether the Android status bar is hidden.
`developerMode` / `usbDebugging`	`false`	Developer options; keep off on production devices.

A short fragment of a configuration looks like this:

```
{
"timeZone": "Europe/Amsterdam",
"wifiSSID": "Office",
"wifiPassword": "secret",
"screenTimeout": 1800,
"displayOrientation": 0
}
```

> **Caution:** Anyone who has the deployment code can apply the configuration, including any Wi-Fi password in it. Share codes only with people who may have that information.

4.3 Editing and deleting

Expand the row and click **Edit** to change the name, description or settings, then **Submit**. Moderators can also change the code (see the caution in 3.4). **Delete** removes the configuration immediately, without confirmation.

5. Deployment Packages

A deployment package delivers several applications and, optionally, one startup configuration with a single code. Use it to set up a device completely in one step. Open it from the menu: **Deployment Packages**.

The list shows the **Code**, **Name**, number of **Applications** and the **Configuration** of each package, newest first. Expanding a row shows the owner, the dates and the deployment order.

5.1 Creating a package

1. Click **Add Package**.
2. Enter a **Name**.
3. Under **Applications**, tick the applications to include. Each application appears once, at its newest version. Applications shared by another user show that user's email address.
4. If you selected more than one application, set the **Deploy order** with the up and down arrows. The device installs them from top to bottom.
5. Optionally choose a **Startup configuration**, or leave it at *None*.
6. Click **Submit**. A message shows the new package code, for example "Package saved with code K7MPA".

A package needs a name and at least one application; until then **Submit** is disabled.

> **Note:** The startup configuration is always applied last, after every application has been installed. Applying it closes the ProDEPLOY Client and hands the settings to the Startup Wizard.

5.2 Packages and new versions

A package follows the application rather than a fixed version. When you add an update to an application (see 3.3), every package that contains it delivers the new version automatically; you do not have to edit the package.

5.3 Editing and deleting

Expand the row and click **Edit** to change the name, the applications, their order or the configuration. Moderators can also change the code (see the caution in 3.4).

If an application or configuration in the package has been deleted, or is no longer shared with you, the form shows it as *Unavailable application* or *Unavailable configuration*. Untick or replace it before saving.

Delete removes the package immediately, without confirmation. The applications and configuration in it are not deleted.

6. Deploying to a device

Once you have a deployment code, you can get it onto a device in two ways:

- **Typing the code** – give the code to the person setting up the device. They enter it in the ProDEPLOY Client and tap **Go**.
- **NFC tag** – write the code to an NFC tag as a plain *text* record (the first record on the tag). Holding the tag against a device with the ProDEPLOY Client open starts the deployment automatically. Any NFC writing app can create such a tag.

The ProDEPLOY Client User Manual describes the device side in detail.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	Cause and solution
A menu item is missing	Your role does not include that page. Ask for a higher role, then log out and in again.
"You do not have the required permissions to access this page."	As above.
The list does not show a recent change	Click the refresh button.
"Saving the application failed"	Check that the name is filled in, the version has a valid format and the code (if entered) is not already in use.
"Version must differ from the current version"	An update needs a new version number.
"The configuration is not valid JSON"	Fix the errors marked in the editor, such as a missing comma or quote.
A device does not receive an application	The device model has no profile in the Device Manager, its Android version is below the minimum SDK, or the newest version has a requirement the device does not meet.
An NFC tag or printed code stopped working	The code was renamed or the item deleted. Write the new code to the tag.
An application cannot be added to a package	It is private and owned by someone else. Ask the owner to share it.